

THE LAST FIVE YEARS · THE SECOND SCREEN

The Cue Bible

build-2026-09-19 · torn score

65 cues · 14 songs · generated from the live show build, so this document cannot drift from what the phones actually do

THE STANDING RULE: the phone behaves exactly like a real phone. Tapping a notification IS the unlock — the app opens directly, no home screen. Inboxes and message lists load whole the instant the app opens, and a full life continues past the bottom edge of the glass. Only what would genuinely arrive right now — a text, a notification, new mail — appears live, and new mail lands at the top. Anything that violates this is a bug, even if it would make a nice theatrical beat.

How to read each entry: the header gives the cue ID, which screen, whose phone, the app, and the musical anchor. ON SCREEN is the complete content, verbatim and untruncated. PLAYS covers mechanics the engine performs on its own — navigation, self-timed animation, synthesized sound. PHONES gives the state after the cue when it changed. Gold notes carry dramaturgy, holds, and open director choices.

1 · Still Hurting CATHY SINGS · 7 FIRES

COLD OPEN, NO PHONE. The falling pages wind down on ONE GO — the title lifts away, the pages thin out, the last one blows off — and the calendar lands: JUNE · YEAR 5, the morning after. On her verse-two line the calendar docks and her phone rises (one GO, plays out): the Memories notification she ignores, Messages, his thread — days of her asking, a Thursday of silence — and she types her text and SENDS. Delivered → READ 9:44. His typing bubble rises. It stops. Then she opens the Memories: four cards, four years, and she drifts back up to the bear — the last image — until the cutoff takes the phone away.

1.1 SR · CATHY — PROLOGUE — *the first note of the wedding waltz*

ONE GO. The title page tears off the pad and falls; beneath it the calendar reads JUNE · YEAR 5, the morning after, and holds center-stage through the whole prologue. No phone, no sound.

ON SCREEN

TIME → 9:41 · Friday, June 12, 2026 — the house reads JUNE · YEAR 5; the calendar pages roll to it (forward tears, backward settles) before any device appears

ERA FOOT LINE → “the morning after”

WALLPAPER — M24 — cast photo of JAMIE — she never changed it

PROLOGUE WIND-DOWN — the falling pages thin out over ~0 s; the last one blows away; the calendar lands

HOLD · `ms` on this cue delays the tear after GO (0 = on the GO). Nothing else moves until her verse-two line.

1.2 SR · CATHY · Messages — “...something wonderful died” — she picks up the phone and sends it

AUTO-PLAYS from this GO (~50 s — slowed by direction; every pause is tunable in tech). The calendar docks; her phone rises, locked — a Facebook Memories notification lands and she ignores it. Unlock, Messages (the whole list is condolences), his thread mid-history — days of her asking, all silent. She types it live, hesitant, and SENDS. Delivered.

ON SCREEN

... a beat (auto-timed, 0.9 s)

NOTIFICATION – Facebook · Memories (now): “You have memories with Jamie Wellerstein to look back on today”

... a beat (auto-timed, 4.5 s)

MESSAGES LIST – loads whole, already full:

- Mom ❤️ • – “call me when you’re up. I love you.” (8:02 AM)
- Dana + girls 🍷 • – “Dana: we’re coming over at 7. non-negotiable.” (7:41 AM)
- Beth – “just heard. I’m so so sorry ❤️” (Yesterday)
- Grammy • – “sweetheart. are you eating?” (Yesterday)
- Aunt Patti – “your mother told me. call me, honey” (Yesterday)
- Jamie – “I’m not angry. just talk to me” (Yesterday)
- Michael (voice) – “no lesson this week – I’m out of town” (Tuesday)
- Ohio Housing – “Re: summer sublet – deposit received” (Monday)
- CVS Pharmacy – “Your prescription is ready for pickup” (Monday)
- Dentist – Dr. Okafor – “Reminder: cleaning Jun 22, 2:30 PM” (Sunday)

... a beat (auto-timed, 3.5 s)

... a beat (auto-timed, 1.6 s)

THREAD HISTORY – loads whole with the thread:

– Sunday · 8:20 PM

SENT (blue): “porch light’s out again. landlord says tuesday”

RECEIVED (gray): “ok”

– Tuesday · 1:15 PM

SENT (blue): “sublet deposit cleared 👍 the room is yours too when you’re here”

RECEIVED (gray): “👍”

– Yesterday · 5:05 AM

SENT (blue): “good morning. can’t wait to see you – what time does your flight land?”

– Yesterday · 1:30 PM

SENT (blue): “landed?”

– Yesterday · 4:40 PM

SENT (blue): “I read it. please call me”

– Yesterday · 9:30 PM

SENT (blue): “I’m not angry. just talk to me”

status: Delivered

... a beat (auto-timed, 3.2 s)

thread caption: Today · 9:41 AM

... a beat (auto-timed, 1.8 s)

TYPES LIVE (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed): “I’m not sure that I can do this without you”

... a beat (auto-timed, 2.6 s)

SEND – the draft springs up into the thread as a blue bubble

delivery status: Delivered

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — CATHY’s screen

sound: receive ding

UNLOCK — the lock slides up and away → home screen · sound: unlock swish

OPENS Messages — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

no animation — the list is already full; the last rows cut off at the bottom of the glass
 “Jamie” takes the iOS pressed-gray under the finger
 TAP COMMITS — the pressed row releases and pushes through · sound: tap
 thread pushes in from the list — Jamie
 sound: key clicks
 sound: send swoosh

SOUND

unlock swish
 send whoosh
 notification tri-tone (soft)
 keyboard clicks (follow the projection rhythm)

PHONES SR = Messages · stamp “the morning after” · clock 9:41

HOLD · *Nothing to fire until her next sung line. If the verse runs long, the Delivered sits — let it.*

1.3 SR · CATHY · Messages — “Give me a day, Jamie!” — Delivered turns to READ

Delivered → READ, 9:44. He is awake. He is holding his phone.

ON SCREEN

TIME → 9:44

STATUS FLIPS → Read 9:44 AM

HOLD · *Let the receipt sit alone for a full phrase.*

1.4 SR · CATHY · Messages — “Hang them back on the wall!” — his typing bubble rises

His typing bubble rises. He is answering.

ON SCREEN

typing indicator rises (three dots)

1.5 SR · CATHY · Messages — “Had no chance at all.” — it stops

It stops. Nothing comes. He read it and put the phone down.

ON SCREEN

typing indicator disappears

HOLD · *The cruellest silence available in Year 5.*

1.6 SR · CATHY · Facebook Memories — “*Jamie is over and where can I turn?*” — *she goes to the memories*

AUTO-PLAYS from this GO (~40 s — slowed by direction: each card’s caption centers, then the eye drifts down into the photograph). She leaves the thread and opens the Memories the notification offered: four cards scroll past — the bear (last year), the wedding, the ring, the couch — then she drifts back up to the bear and holds on it.

ON SCREEN

... a beat (auto-timed, 1.8 s)

MEMORY CARD — 1 year ago — Cathy Wellerstein · June 12

post: “Ohio round 2 day 1”

media: M2 — Jamie giving Cathy the bear

reactions: 👍 64

... a beat (auto-timed, 5.0 s)

MEMORY CARD — 2 years ago — Cathy Wellerstein · June 12

post: “married three weeks and 600 miles apart. worth it.”

media: M4 — the wedding portrait

reactions: 👍 402

... a beat (auto-timed, 5.0 s)

MEMORY CARD — 3 years ago — Cathy Wellerstein · June 12

post: “he asked. I said yes before he finished 💍”

media: M3a — the ring, the rowboat

reactions: 👍 341

... a beat (auto-timed, 5.0 s)

MEMORY CARD — 4 years ago — Cathy Wellerstein · June 12

post: “nine months in and our apartment has a name. it is called The Couch.”

media: M15 — the hideous couch

reactions: 👍 88

... a beat (auto-timed, 1.8 s)

SCROLLS BACK — she drifts up the feed to card 1 and holds on it

PLAYS

OPENS Facebook — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

the feed advances one full-screen card · sound: soft pop

PHONES SR = Facebook Memories · stamp “the morning after” · clock 9:44

HOLD · *The bear card is the last thing she looks at. Let the camera sit.*

1.7 SR · CATHY — *FINAL CUTOFF* — *the last chord of Still Hurting*

The phone drops; the calendar returns to center — JUNE · YEAR 5 holds until his song rolls it back.

ON SCREEN

PHONE AWAY — the phone drops; the calendar returns to center-stage

PLAYS

the device drops; the calendar takes center-stage (never black — true black is the curtain only)

SOUND

room tone out

2 · Shiksa Goddess **JAMIE SINGS · 4 FIRES**

THE FIRST NIGHT, FROM HIS SIDE. Three overwrought drafts die under the backspace key before two words survive: “home safe?” — the exact text the finale receives the same night. She answers by calling instead. His hesitation here is the measure for how fast he moves in 13.

2.1 SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — *TOP OF SHIKSA GODDESS — the first chord, as he enters*

The calendar rolls BACK five years, page by page — JUNE · YEAR 5 → SEPTEMBER · YEAR 1 — then docks, and HIS phone rises, locked, walking home: three unread on the lock screen, her number on top.

ON SCREEN

TIME → 11:38 · Friday, September 3, 2021 — the house reads SEPTEMBER · YEAR 1; the calendar pages roll to it (forward tears, backward settles) before any device appears

ERA FOOT LINE → “the first night”

NOTIFICATION — Messages · Mom ❤️ (3h ago): “dinner sunday. no excuses.”

NOTIFICATION — Messages · Rob (1h ago): “well??? how’d it go”

NOTIFICATION — Messages · +1 (917) 555-0148 (56m ago): “it’s cathy 😊 — from tonight”

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — JAMIE’s screen

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

PHONES SL = Lock screen · stamp “the first night” · clock 11:38

2.2 SL · JAMIE · Messages — “I’m breaking my mother’s heart” — THE SECOND TIME

ONE PIECE, AUTO-PLAYS from this GO (~50 s). Unlock, Messages, her thread — one message in it: her number. Three drafts die under the backspace key (the overwrought one, the bold one, the honest one) before two words survive: “home safe?” — typed, SENT, Delivered. Then her typing bubble rises... and stays up.

ON SCREEN

MESSAGES LIST — loads whole, already full:

- +1 (917) 555-0148 • — “it’s cathy 😊 — from tonight” (10:42 PM)
- Rob • — “well??? how’d it go” (10:12 PM)
- Mom ❤️ • — “dinner sunday. no excuses.” (8:05 PM)
- Dr. Adler — “gave your name to an agent — Ms. Whitfield. call her office.” (Yesterday)
- Elissa Weiss — “it was fun, but...” (Tuesday)
- H. Greenblatt — “ok. good luck with the book I guess” (Monday)
- S. Rosen — “I’ll call you this week” (2 wks ago)
- Columbia workshop — “Adam: notes attached for Thursday” (2 wks ago)

... a beat (auto-timed, 1.2 s)

THREAD HISTORY — loads whole with the thread:

— Today · 10:42 PM

RECEIVED (gray): “it’s cathy 😊 — from tonight”

... a beat (auto-timed, 1.2 s)

TIME → 11:39

TYPES LIVE (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed): “Tonight was maybe the best night of my whole life”

... a beat (auto-timed, 3.8 s)

BACKSPACES the draft to nothing (fast rattle)

... a beat (auto-timed, 2.0 s)

TYPES LIVE (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed): “So when can I see you again. Tomorrow?”

... a beat (auto-timed, 3.4 s)

BACKSPACES the draft to nothing (fast rattle)

... a beat (auto-timed, 1.8 s)

TIME → 11:44

TYPES LIVE (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed): “ok so I know this is fast but”

... a beat (auto-timed, 2.6 s)

BACKSPACES the draft to nothing (fast rattle)

... a beat (auto-timed, 4.2 s)

TIME → 11:48

thread caption: · 11:48 PM

TYPES LIVE (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed): “home safe?”

... a beat (auto-timed, 2.4 s)

SEND — the draft springs up into the thread as a blue bubble

delivery status: Delivered

... a beat (auto-timed, 4.2 s)

typing indicator rises (three dots)

PLAYS

UNLOCK — the lock slides up and away → home screen · sound: unlock swish

OPENS Messages — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

no animation — the list is already full; the last rows cut off at the bottom of the glass

“+1 (917) 555-0148” takes the iOS pressed-gray under the finger

TAP COMMITS — the pressed row releases and pushes through · sound: tap

thread pushes in from the list — +1 (917) 555-0148

sound: key clicks

sound: backspace rattle

sound: send swoosh

SOUND

unlock swish
 send whoosh
 keyboard clicks (follow the projection rhythm)
 rapid delete clicks

PHONES SL = Messages · stamp “the first night” · clock 11:48

HOLD · *Nothing to fire until her call. The finale receives this exact text at 11:48.*

2.3 SL · JAMIE · Phone — “If you had a pierced tongue” — he is *ON THE PHONE* with Cathy

The bubble never resolves as a text — she called instead. Incoming, then connected; the timer ticks.

ON SCREEN

CALL SCREEN — +1 (917) 555-0148 · incoming call · incoming
 ... a beat (auto-timed, 3.2 s)
call state → connected · 00:00

SOUND

ring — outgoing ringback, or the ringtone when dir is in

PHONES SL = Phone · stamp “the first night” · clock 11:48

2.4 SL · JAMIE — “...waiting for someone like—” (cut off) — *HE HANGS UP*; phone away

Call Ended, the phone drops, the calendar returns: SEPTEMBER · YEAR 1 holds. Nothing else until See I’m Smiling.

ON SCREEN

PHONE AWAY — the phone drops; the calendar returns to center-stage

PLAYS

the device drops; the calendar takes center-stage (never black — true black is the curtain only)

SOUND

room tone out

3 · See I'm Smiling BOTH SING · 10 FIRES

HER SONG, HIS CALLS. She has no phone in this number: the era holds center-stage while she sings. Then his 2021 calls cut in — the agent cold call, the callback, and Rob (he dials, per the script) — and each hang-up rolls the time home to her July. The house learns the projections can time-travel.

3.1 BOTH · CATHY — TOP OF SEE I'M SMILING — the first chord (the pier)

No phone for her, by direction. The calendar rolls FORWARD, page by page — SEPTEMBER · YEAR 1 → JULY · YEAR 4, her birthday in Ohio — and holds while she sings.

ON SCREEN

PHONE AWAY — the phone drops; the calendar returns to center-stage

TIME → 6:12 · Saturday, July 19, 2025 — the house reads JULY · YEAR 4; the calendar pages roll to it (forward tears, backward settles) before any device appears

ERA FOOT LINE → "Ohio · her birthday"

PLAYS

the device drops; the calendar takes center-stage (never black — true black is the curtain only)

SOUND

room tone out

3.2 BOTH · JAMIE · Phone — "And you're mine... We're doing fine." — JAMIE DIALS. Time snaps back.

The calendar rolls BACK to SEPTEMBER · YEAR 1 and docks; HIS phone rises already dialing — a cold call to the agent, via Dr. Adler ("Ms. Whitfield (office)", from Adler's text). Ringback under it.

ON SCREEN

TIME → 2:41 · Tuesday, September 7, 2021 — the house reads SEPTEMBER · YEAR 1; the calendar pages roll to it (forward tears, backward settles) before any device appears

ERA FOOT LINE → clears

CALL SCREEN — Ms. Whitfield (office) · calling... · outgoing

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — JAMIE's screen

SOUND

ring — outgoing ringback, or the ringtone when dir is in

PHONES BOTH = Phone · clock 2:41

3.3 BOTH · JAMIE · Phone — JAMIE: "Hi, I'm calling for Ms. Whitfield" — it connects

Connected — the timer ticks while the conversation runs.

ON SCREEN

call state → connected · 00:00

3.4 BOTH · JAMIE — JAMIE: "What's your address?" — his last words; he hangs up

Call Ended; the phone drops; the calendar comes back to center and rolls FORWARD home — SEPTEMBER · YEAR 1 → JULY · YEAR 4.

ON SCREEN

PHONE AWAY — the phone drops; the calendar returns to center-stage

TIME → 6:31 · Saturday, July 19, 2025 — the house reads JULY · YEAR 4; the calendar pages roll to it (forward tears, backward settles) before any device appears

ERA FOOT LINE → "Ohio · her birthday"

PLAYS

the device drops; the calendar takes center-stage (never black — true black is the curtain only)

SOUND

room tone out

3.5 BOTH · JAMIE · Phone — *“It’s all right — We’ll have tonight.” — the agent calls HIM back*

The calendar rolls BACK and docks; HIS phone rises with an INCOMING call from Ms. Whitfield — two weeks later (script). The ring under it.

ON SCREEN

TIME → 4:18 · Tuesday, September 21, 2021 — the house reads SEPTEMBER · YEAR 1; the calendar pages roll to it (forward tears, backward settles) before any device appears

ERA FOOT LINE → clears

CALL SCREEN — Ms. Whitfield (office) · incoming call · incoming

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — JAMIE’s screen

SOUND

ring — outgoing ringback, or the ringtone when dir is in

PHONES BOTH = Phone · clock 4:18

3.6 BOTH · JAMIE · Phone — *JAMIE: “Hello? This is... Oh, Ms. Whitfield” — he answers*

Connected. It runs until the thank-you.

ON SCREEN

call state → connected · 00:00

3.7 BOTH · JAMIE — *JAMIE: “Thank you, this is great.” — it ends*

Again: Call Ended, the phone drops, the calendar rolls FORWARD to her evening.

ON SCREEN

PHONE AWAY — the phone drops; the calendar returns to center-stage

TIME → 6:47 · Saturday, July 19, 2025 — the house reads JULY · YEAR 4; the calendar pages roll to it (forward tears, backward settles) before any device appears

ERA FOOT LINE → “Ohio · her birthday”

PLAYS

the device drops; the calendar takes center-stage (never black — true black is the curtain only)

SOUND

room tone out

3.8 BOTH · JAMIE · Phone — *“And not do anything at all...” — JAMIE DIALS ROB*

SCRIPT: he dials — “perplexed but not unhappy.” The calendar rolls BACK and docks; his phone rises dialing Rob. The lease is up; an apartment WITH Cathy.

ON SCREEN

TIME → 8:02 · Thursday, September 30, 2021 — the house reads SEPTEMBER · YEAR 1; the calendar pages roll to it (forward tears, backward settles) before any device appears

ERA FOOT LINE → clears

CALL SCREEN — Rob · calling mobile... · outgoing

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — JAMIE’s screen

SOUND

ring — outgoing ringback, or the ringtone when dir is in

PHONES BOTH = Phone · clock 8:02

3.9 BOTH · JAMIE · Phone — *JAMIE: “Rob? Yeah, listen.” — Rob picks up*

Connected — visible through the very end of the vamp.

ON SCREEN

call state → connected · 00:00

3.10 BOTH · JAMIE — DOWNBEAT OF MOVING TOO FAST — *he hangs up*

Call Ended on the downbeat; the phone drops; one page tears — OCTOBER · YEAR 1, center-stage.

ON SCREEN

PHONE AWAY — the phone drops; the calendar returns to center-stage

TIME → 2:14 · Friday, October 8, 2021 — the house reads OCTOBER · YEAR 1; the calendar pages roll to it (forward tears, backward settles) before any device appears

ERA FOOT LINE → clears

PLAYS

the device drops; the calendar takes center-stage (never black — true black is the curtain only)

SOUND

room tone out

4 · Moving Too Fast BOTH SING · 9 FIRES

THE AVALANCHE, COMPRESSED. Her one professional call — dial, connect, end, then his phone rolls back — and his lock screen wins five times in the exact order he sings them: the apartment, the Atlantic, the money, Columbia, Sonny. The happy infrastructure of the marriage installs itself so the back half can dismantle it.

4.1 BOTH · CATHY · Phone — “But oh, oh — what else am I s’posed to do?” — CATHY DIALS

The calendar rolls FORWARD — OCTOBER · YEAR 1 → MAY · YEAR 4 (pinned by David: her backward line, between the pier and the party) — and docks; HER phone rises dialing Mike Stelmyer. His agency is never named (script).

ON SCREEN

TIME → 10:10 · Friday, May 9, 2025 — the house reads MAY · YEAR 4; the calendar pages roll to it (forward tears, backward settles) before any device appears

ERA FOOT LINE → clears

CALL SCREEN — Mike Stelmyer · calling... · outgoing

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — CATHY’s screen

SOUND

ring — outgoing ringback, or the ringtone when dir is in

PHONES BOTH = Phone · clock 10:10

4.2 BOTH · CATHY · Phone — END OF “...what else am I s’posed to do?” — it connects; she speaks next

We see the dial AND the connect; the timer ticks under her call.

ON SCREEN

call state → connected · 00:00

4.3 BOTH · JAMIE · Lock screen — CATHY: “I’ll call you soon!” — the call ends; back to HIS phone

Call Ended; her phone drops; the calendar rolls BACK — MAY · YEAR 4 → OCTOBER · YEAR 1 — and docks; his phone rises, locked, ready for the run of wins.

ON SCREEN

PHONE AWAY — the phone drops; the calendar returns to center-stage

TIME → 2:14 · Friday, October 8, 2021 — the house reads OCTOBER · YEAR 1; the calendar pages roll to it (forward tears, backward settles) before any device appears

ERA FOOT LINE → clears

PLAYS

the device drops; the calendar takes center-stage (never black — true black is the curtain only)

the iPhone shell appears — JAMIE’s screen

SOUND

room tone out

PHONES BOTH = Lock screen · clock 2:14

4.4 BOTH · JAMIE · Lock screen — “Found an apartment on Seventy-Third!”

Move-in day pops up, both names on the day.

ON SCREEN

NOTIFICATION — Calendar · Invitation: MOVE-IN DAY 🚚 — W 73rd St (now): “Cathy Hiatt invited you · Saturday, Oct 16, 9:00 AM”

PLAYS

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

4.5 BOTH · JAMIE · Lock screen — “*The Atlantic Monthly’s printing my first chapter*”

The Atlantic says yes.

ON SCREEN

NOTIFICATION – Mail · The Atlantic Monthly (now): “We are delighted to publish your excerpt”

PLAYS

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

4.6 BOTH · JAMIE · Lock screen — “*Two thousand bucks without rewriting one word!*”

The deposit lands.

ON SCREEN

NOTIFICATION – Chase (now): “You received a deposit of \$2,000.00”

PLAYS

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

4.7 BOTH · JAMIE · Lock screen — “*I left Columbia and don’t regret it*”

The withdrawal confirmation.

ON SCREEN

NOTIFICATION – Mail · Columbia University (now): “Withdrawal processed – Fall term ✓”

PLAYS

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

4.8 BOTH · JAMIE · Lock screen — “*I wrote a book and Sonny Mehta read it!*”

THE BIGGEST HIT.

ON SCREEN

NOTIFICATION – Messages · Linda Whitfield (now): “SONNY READ IT. CALL ME NOW.”

PLAYS

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

4.9 BOTH · JAMIE — *FINAL CHORD* — *the last hit of Moving Too Fast*

The phone drops; OCTOBER · YEAR 1 holds center until her song rolls it forward.

ON SCREEN

PHONE AWAY – the phone drops; the calendar returns to center-stage

PLAYS

the device drops; the calendar takes center-stage (never black — true black is the curtain only)

SOUND

room tone out

5 · I'm a Part of That **CATHY SINGS · 1 FIRES**

CALENDAR ONLY, BY DIRECTION. The pages roll forward to MARCH · YEAR 4, the book party, and hold center-stage for the whole song. No phone — the dedication is cut.

5.1 **SR · CATHY** — *TOP OF I'M A PART OF THAT* — *the first notes of the intro*

Calendar only, by direction (the dedication is cut). The pages roll FORWARD — OCTOBER · YEAR 1 → MARCH · YEAR 4, the book party — and hold for the whole song.

ON SCREEN

PHONE AWAY — the phone drops; the calendar returns to center-stage

TIME → 8:12 · Saturday, March 8, 2025 — the house reads MARCH · YEAR 4; the calendar pages roll to it (forward tears, backward settles) before any device appears

ERA FOOT LINE → “the book party”

PLAYS

the device drops; the calendar takes center-stage (never black — true black is the curtain only)

SOUND

room tone out

6 · The Schmuel Song **JAMIE SINGS · 2 FIRES**

STILLNESS, BY DIRECTION. One held Christmas lock screen. No animation, no cueing inside the number — the kindest screen of the night, deliberately so; the generosity buys the betrayal its full price later. Not one Elise pixel anywhere in this song.

6.1 SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — *TOP OF THE SCHMUEL SONG* — *the tree lights come up, before he speaks*

The calendar rolls BACK — MARCH · YEAR 4 → DECEMBER · YEAR 2 — and docks; his phone rises, locked, the Christmas wallpaper (M23). No animations: the phone keeps the season for the whole song.

ON SCREEN

TIME → 9:12 · Saturday, December 24, 2022 — the house reads DECEMBER · YEAR 2; the calendar pages roll to it (forward tears, backward settles) before any device appears

ERA FOOT LINE → “their second Christmas”

WALLPAPER — M23 — Christmas tree lights

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — JAMIE’s screen

PHONES SL = Lock screen · stamp “their second Christmas” · clock 9:12

6.2 SL · JAMIE — *FINAL CHORD* — *after the watch, the last note*

The phone drops; DECEMBER · YEAR 2 holds center.

ON SCREEN

PHONE AWAY — the phone drops; the calendar returns to center-stage

PLAYS

the device drops; the calendar takes center-stage (never black — true black is the curtain only)

SOUND

room tone out

7 · A Summer in Ohio CATHY SINGS · 3 FIRES

ONE CALL. Ringing on the vamp, he answers on her first line, the prerecorded FaceTime (V2) carries the entire number — Jamie at his desk, half-attending, writing, while Ohio sings to him — and Call Ended on the final chord. The engine draws only the FaceTime chrome and the ticking duration; everything alive in it is the video.

7.1 SR · CATHY · FaceTime — *TOP OF A SUMMER IN OHIO* — *the intro vamp; she places the call*

The calendar rolls FORWARD — DECEMBER · YEAR 2 → JUNE · YEAR 3 — and docks; her laptop rises and she places the FaceTime call: the RINGING screen, his initial pulsing, the FaceTime ring under it.

ON SCREEN

TIME → 9:38 · Friday, June 21, 2024 — the house reads JUNE · YEAR 3; the calendar pages roll to it (forward tears, backward settles) before any device appears

ERA FOOT LINE → “Ohio”

FACETIME — Jamie ❤️ · FaceTime...

PLAYS

the MacBook shell appears — CATHY’s screen

SOUND

FaceTime trill, then connect pop

PHONES SR = FaceTime · stamp “Ohio” · clock 9:38

7.2 SR · CATHY · FaceTime — *“I could have a mansion on a hill”* — *her first line; HE ANSWERS*

He answers. The prerecorded FaceTime (V2) plays for the entire number — only Jamie, no Cathy self-view — with the real FaceTime overlays and a ticking call duration.

ON SCREEN

FaceTime state → connected

HOLD · *Nothing else to fire until the final chord. The video carries the number.*

7.3 SR · CATHY — *FINAL CHORD* — *the last note; the call ends and she closes the laptop*

Call Ended (his initial dimmed, the end tone), a breath, then the laptop drops — JUNE · YEAR 3 holds center until the wedding rolls it.

ON SCREEN

FaceTime state → Call Ended

... a beat (auto-timed, 2.6 s)

PHONE AWAY — the phone drops; the calendar returns to center-stage

PLAYS

the device drops; the calendar takes center-stage (never black — true black is the curtain only)

SOUND

room tone out

8 · The Next Ten Minutes **BOTH SING · 4 FIRES**

TIME, NOT CONTENT. No phone. The calendar alone marks where we are: JUNE · YEAR 2, the rowboat — then the one date both timelines share, MAY · YEAR 3, the wedding — then back to the rowboat on the singers' lines. The final chord brings up the INTERMISSION pages, which hold until Act Two's first GO.

8.1 **BOTH · CATHY** — *JAMIE: “No, that one’s Jerry Seinfeld” — his first line, in the rowboat*

No phones, by direction. The calendar rolls BACK — JUNE · YEAR 3 → JUNE · YEAR 2, the engagement — and holds.

ON SCREEN

PHONE AWAY — the phone drops; the calendar returns to center-stage

TIME → 4:44 · Monday, June 12, 2023 — the house reads JUNE · YEAR 2; the calendar pages roll to it (forward tears, backward settles) before any device appears

ERA FOOT LINE → “the rowboat”

PLAYS

the device drops; the calendar takes center-stage (never black — true black is the curtain only)

SOUND

room tone out

8.2 **BOTH · CATHY** — *JAMIE: “For the next ten lifetimes?” — the altar*

The pages tear FORWARD to the only date both timelines will ever share — MAY · YEAR 3 · THE WEDDING.

ON SCREEN

TIME → 6:47 · Saturday, May 18, 2024 — the house reads MAY · YEAR 3; the calendar pages roll to it (forward tears, backward settles) before any device appears

ERA FOOT LINE → “the wedding”

8.3 **BOTH · CATHY** — *CATHY: “Is that one John Lennon?” — back in the boat*

The pages settle BACK to the engagement — JUNE · YEAR 2.

ON SCREEN

TIME → 4:44 · Monday, June 12, 2023 — the house reads JUNE · YEAR 2; the calendar pages roll to it (forward tears, backward settles) before any device appears

ERA FOOT LINE → “the rowboat”

8.4 **BOTH · CATHY** — *FINAL CHORD — the lights fade on the boat. END OF ACT ONE*

INTERMISSION: the calendar's top page reads Intermission and holds, still, through the break; the first GO of Act Two (9.1) tears it off.

ON SCREEN

INTERMISSION CARD — the house sees “Intermission”; it holds until Act Two's first GO

9 · A Miracle Would Happen JAMIE SINGS · 7 FIRES

NOTIFICATIONS ONLY. His married year arrives as a stack he never touches — readers, the growing book, Elise, front row. The phone will not stop, and he never once interacts with it. The attention just lands.

9.1 SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — *TOP OF ACT TWO — the first notes of the vamp, before he sings*

The pages clear; the calendar lands and rolls FORWARD — JUNE · YEAR 2 → OCTOBER · YEAR 4 — then docks; his phone rises, locked. Married, at a party, and the phone will not stop. He never touches it; the attention just arrives.

ON SCREEN

TIME → 11:22 · Friday, October 18, 2024 — the house reads OCTOBER · YEAR 4; the calendar pages roll to it (forward tears, backward settles) before any device appears

ERA FOOT LINE → “five months married”

WALLPAPER — M4 — the wedding portrait

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — JAMIE’s screen

PHONES SL = Lock screen · stamp “five months married” · clock 11:22

9.2 SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — “...suddenly finds you attractive”

A reader.

ON SCREEN

NOTIFICATION — Instagram · a.reader.somewhere (now): “commented: okay the ending WRECKED me. how are you real”

PLAYS

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

9.3 SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — “And now they’re banging down your door”

And another.

ON SCREEN

NOTIFICATION — Instagram · lit.with.lena (now): “wants to send you a message”

PLAYS

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

9.4 SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — “I’m the grand fromage”

The book keeps growing without him — his agent, not a stranger, says so.

ON SCREEN

TIME → 11:25

NOTIFICATION — Messages · Linda Whitfield (now): “third printing confirmed. do NOT post it yet 🍷”

PLAYS

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

9.5 SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — “Let’s get a cup of coffee.”

And Elise (the editor at Random House — the woman in this verse is unnamed in the score; the screen names her).

ON SCREEN

NOTIFICATION – Messages · Elise (Random House) (now): “paperback cover is in 🎉 celebratory drink sometime?”

PLAYS

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

9.6 SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — “It’s a challenge to resist temptation” — *THE SECOND TIME* (after the party)

Front row. (△CONFIRM which occurrence of the phrase — David pins it on the Cue Sheet.)

ON SCREEN

TIME → 11:29

NOTIFICATION – Instagram · novel.annie (now): “commented: front row at your reading tonight 🤔”

PLAYS

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

9.7 SL · JAMIE — *FINAL CHORD* — the last note of the song

The phone drops; OCTOBER · YEAR 4 holds center.

ON SCREEN

PHONE AWAY – the phone drops; the calendar returns to center-stage

PLAYS

the device drops; the calendar takes center-stage (never black — true black is the curtain only)

SOUND

room tone out

10 · Climbing Uphill CATHY SINGS · 6 FIRES

TWO TEXTS, THREE MONTHS APART. “break a leg” lands before her first note — lowercase, three seconds of effort — then two rejection emails over the lock screen. On the bell tone, time rolls back to November 2023 and his other text arrives: long, thoughtful, the man he was. The contrast is the whole cue.

10.1 SR · CATHY · Lock screen — TOP OF CLIMBING UPHILL — *the intro, before her first note*

The calendar rolls BACK — OCTOBER · YEAR 4 → FEBRUARY · YEAR 3 — and docks; her phone rises, locked, in the audition hallway. A sign-in reminder sits on the lock screen; then his text lands on top: “break a leg” — lowercase, three seconds of effort.

ON SCREEN

TIME → 9:52 · Monday, February 5, 2024 — the house reads FEBRUARY · YEAR 3; the calendar pages roll to it (forward tears, backward settles) before any device appears

ERA FOOT LINE → “audition season”

NOTIFICATION — Mail · Casting Networks (8:14 AM): “Reminder: sign-in opens 10:00 AM — Equity chorus call”

... a beat (auto-timed, 1.1 s)

NOTIFICATION — Messages · Jamie ❤️ (now): “break a leg”

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — CATHY’s screen

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

PHONES SR = Lock screen · stamp “audition season” · clock 9:52

10.2 SR · CATHY · Lock screen — CATHY: “Okay, thank you. Thank you so much.” — *her first spoken line*

A rejection lands over the lock screen — last week’s audition, answered. Just enough to read: they are not moving forward.

ON SCREEN

NOTIFICATION — Mail · Meridian Stage Company – Casting (now): “Thank you for auditioning. We will not be moving forward at this time, but we hope to see you...”

PLAYS

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

10.3 SR · CATHY · Lock screen — “Belting as high as they can!”

Another one. A callback that went the other way.

ON SCREEN

NOTIFICATION — Mail · Northfield Summer Playhouse (now): “Re: your callback — we have decided to go in another direction. We will keep your...”

PLAYS

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

10.4 SR · CATHY — “Grant me Grace!” — *she puts the phone away*

The phone drops; FEBRUARY · YEAR 3 holds center while she sings.

ON SCREEN

PHONE AWAY — the phone drops; the calendar returns to center-stage

PLAYS

the device drops; the calendar takes center-stage (never black — true black is the curtain only)

SOUND

room tone out

10.5 SR · CATHY · Messages — *THE BELL TONE* — *before the audition where we hear her thoughts*

FLASHBACK, AUTO-PLAYS from this GO. The pages settle BACK three months — FEBRUARY → NOVEMBER · YEAR 3 — and dock; her phone rises: a text from him, long and thoughtful, the night before an earlier callback. She opens it; the thread shows the man he was three months ago.

ON SCREEN

TIME → 9:48 · Wednesday, November 8, 2023 — the house reads NOVEMBER · YEAR 3; the calendar pages roll to it (forward tears, backward settles) before any device appears

ERA FOOT LINE → “three months earlier”

... a beat (auto-timed, 0.6 s)

NOTIFICATION — Messages · Jamie ❤️ (now): “You are going to walk in there tomorrow and be the best thing they see all week. I mean it. Whatever happens in that room, you are already the real thing — I have known that since the first night. Go get it, and call me the second you are out. I love you.”

... a beat (auto-timed, 1.8 s)

THREAD HISTORY — loads whole with the thread:

— Tuesday · 8:15 PM

SENT (blue): “callback thursday. 9am. help”

RECEIVED (gray): “you’ve got this. what are you singing?”

SENT (blue): “the one you like”

— Today · 9:48 PM

RECEIVED (gray): “You are going to walk in there tomorrow and be the best thing they see all week. I mean it. Whatever happens in that room, you are already the real thing — I have known that since the first night. Go get it, and call me the second you are out. I love you.”

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — CATHY’s screen

sound: receive ding

TAP THE NOTIFICATION — a beat on the banner, Face ID passes, and the app opens DIRECTLY onto Messages. One motion. No home screen. (No touch dot anywhere in the show — cut by direction; the screen’s own feedback carries every tap.)

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

tap thock

PHONES SR = Messages · stamp “three months earlier” · clock 9:48

HOLD · *The contrast IS the cue: three seconds of effort in February, a paragraph in November.*

10.6 SR · CATHY — JAMIE: “Cathy, what are you doing now?” — *his phone scene begins*

The phone drops; the pages tear FORWARD home — NOVEMBER → FEBRUARY · YEAR 3 — and hold center to the end of the song.

ON SCREEN

PHONE AWAY — the phone drops; the calendar returns to center-stage

TIME → 9:52 · Monday, February 5, 2024 — the house reads FEBRUARY · YEAR 3; the calendar pages roll to it (forward tears, backward settles) before any device appears

ERA FOOT LINE → “audition season”

PLAYS

the device drops; the calendar takes center-stage (never black — true black is the curtain only)

SOUND

room tone out

11 · If I Didn't Believe In You **JAMIE SINGS · 1 FIRES**

TIMELINE ONLY. One GO: time rolls forward to MARCH 2026, the night of the party, and holds center-stage for the whole fight. Nothing on a phone — the argument is the screen.

11.1 **SL · JAMIE** — *JAMIE: “Okay, stop. Cathy, stop.” — his first words*

Calendar only, by direction. The pages tear FORWARD — FEBRUARY · YEAR 3 → MARCH · YEAR 5, the night of the party — and hold for the whole fight.

ON SCREEN

PHONE AWAY — the phone drops; the calendar returns to center-stage

TIME → 7:41 · Friday, March 6, 2026 — the house reads MARCH · YEAR 5; the calendar pages roll to it (forward tears, backward settles) before any device appears

ERA FOOT LINE → “the night of the party”

PLAYS

the device drops; the calendar takes center-stage (never black — true black is the curtain only)

SOUND

room tone out

12 · I Can Do Better Than That CATHY SINGS · 2 FIRES

THE DRIVE, ON THE DASH. CarPlay for the entire song: Apple Maps, the puck rides the route from New York to the Eastern Shore, the miles and minutes fall, each maneuver counts down, the dash clock runs 4:05 to 7:45. Arrival is timed to the song (tune `dur` in tech). On the final chord the dash goes dark and NOVEMBER · YEAR 1 holds.

12.1 SR · CATHY · Maps — navigating — *TOP OF I CAN DO BETTER THAN THAT — the first note of the vamp*

The calendar rolls BACK — MARCH · YEAR 5 → NOVEMBER · YEAR 1 — and docks; the dash lights up — CarPlay, already navigating; Apple Maps, New York → the Eastern Shore, the car's display filling the frame. The drive really moves for the whole song: the puck rides the route, the miles and minutes fall, each maneuver counts down, and the dash clock runs 4:05 → 7:45. Arrival lands five minutes after this GO.

ON SCREEN

TIME → 4:05 · Saturday, November 6, 2021 — the house reads NOVEMBER · YEAR 1; the calendar pages roll to it (forward tears, backward settles) before any device appears

ERA FOOT LINE → “the drive”

MAPS — THE DRIVE (live, time-based from this GO): St. Michaels — the Eastern Shore · arrival in 5 min of stage time

compressed trip: 220 min / 214 mi · the puck rides the route, maneuvers count down, the phone clock runs with it

PLAYS

the CarPlay (the dash) shell appears — CATHY's screen

PHONES SR = Maps — navigating · stamp “the drive” · clock 4:05

HOLD · `dur` (seconds to arrival) lives on this cue in cues.js — match it to the song in tech. After arrival the screen holds on “You have arrived.”

12.2 SR · CATHY — *FINAL CHORD — the last note of the song*

The dash goes dark; NOVEMBER · YEAR 1 holds center.

ON SCREEN

PHONE AWAY — the phone drops; the calendar returns to center-stage

PLAYS

the device drops; the calendar takes center-stage (never black — true black is the curtain only)

SOUND

room tone out

13 · Nobody Needs to Know JAMIE SINGS · 3 FIRES

TWO BEATS. Her good-morning text lights his phone and he swipes it away, unread, at once. On his last line he opens Find My and turns his location back ON — Share Indefinitely — the cover-up filed as devotion. It was off before the song; we never see him turn it off.

13.1 SL · JAMIE — *TOP OF NOBODY NEEDS TO KNOW — the first note, before he sings*

The pages tear FORWARD — NOVEMBER · YEAR 1 → JUNE · YEAR 5, before dawn — and hold. His phone is face-down somewhere it should not be.

ON SCREEN

PHONE AWAY — the phone drops; the calendar returns to center-stage

BATTERY → 9%

TIME → 5:05 · Thursday, June 11, 2026 — the house reads JUNE · YEAR 5; the calendar pages roll to it (forward tears, backward settles) before any device appears

ERA FOOT LINE → “before dawn”

PLAYS

the device drops; the calendar takes center-stage (never black — true black is the curtain only)

SOUND

room tone out

13.2 SL · JAMIE — “Cathy is waiting” — *her text lands*

AUTO-PLAYS from this GO. The calendar docks; his phone lights on the nightstand — 9% battery — with her good-morning text. He swipes it away immediately, unread, and the phone drops again. JUNE · YEAR 5 holds.

ON SCREEN

NOTIFICATION — Messages · Cathy 🍷 (now): “good morning. can’t wait to see you — what time does your flight land?”

... a beat (auto-timed, 1.5 s)

notification SWIPED AWAY — slides off and is gone

... a beat (auto-timed, 0.9 s)

PHONE AWAY — the phone drops; the calendar returns to center-stage

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — JAMIE’s screen

sound: receive ding

the device drops; the calendar takes center-stage (never black — true black is the curtain only)

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

room tone out

13.3 SL · JAMIE · Find My — “...in love with someone like you” — his last line; *Find My*, location back ON

The calendar docks; his phone rises: unlock, Find My, her card — she is in Ohio, and he has not been sharing back. Share My Location → Share Indefinitely. The green check is the last image of the song: the cover-up, filed as devotion.

ON SCREEN

TIME → 5:24

FIND MY – her card: Cathy 🧡 · Mount Orab, OH · [Share My Location] (blue)

... a beat (auto-timed, 0.8 s)

FINGER RESTS ON [Share My Location] – the button holds its pressed shade. Not pressing.

ACTION SHEET slides up over the app – “Share your location with Cathy 🧡?”

buttons: [Share for One Hour] · [Share Until End of Day] · [Share Indefinitely] · [Cancel]

FINGER RESTS ON [Share Indefinitely] – the button holds its pressed shade. Not pressing.

PRESSES [Share Indefinitely]

FIND MY – her card: Cathy 🧡 · Mount Orab, OH · Sharing My Location ✓ Indefinitely (green) · [Stop Sharing My Location] (red)

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — JAMIE’s screen

UNLOCK — the lock slides up and away → home screen · sound: unlock swish

OPENS FindMy — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

SOUND

unlock swish

PHONES SL = Find My · stamp “before dawn” · clock 5:24

HOLD · Location was OFF before the song (we never see him turn it off). Hold on this screen through the final chord; 14.1 takes it away.

14 · Goodbye Until Tomorrow / I Could Never Rescue You **BOTH**

SING · 6 FIRES

THE GRAMMAR RESOLVES. The era flips with the singer. Her one animation: his “home safe?” lands on her steps, she opens it, and she is still typing her answer when his last verse rolls the time forward to JUNE 2026 — the last image. True black on the final goodbye.

14.1 **BOTH · CATHY** — *TOP OF THE FINALE* — the intro, before her first line

The phone drops; the calendar rolls BACK — JUNE · YEAR 5 → SEPTEMBER · YEAR 1, the first night — and holds while she sings.

ON SCREEN

PHONE AWAY — the phone drops; the calendar returns to center-stage

TIME → 11:40 · Friday, September 3, 2021 — the house reads SEPTEMBER · YEAR 1; the calendar pages roll to it (forward tears, backward settles) before any device appears

ERA FOOT LINE → “the first night”

PLAYS

the device drops; the calendar takes center-stage (never black — true black is the curtain only)

SOUND

room tone out

14.2 **BOTH · CATHY** — *JAMIE: “I called Elise to help me pack my bags”* — his first line

His half: the pages tear FORWARD — SEPTEMBER · YEAR 1 → JUNE · YEAR 5, his last afternoon.

ON SCREEN

TIME → 2:40 · Thursday, June 11, 2026 — the house reads JUNE · YEAR 5; the calendar pages roll to it (forward tears, backward settles) before any device appears

ERA FOOT LINE → “the last afternoon”

14.3 **BOTH · CATHY** — *CATHY: “Goodbye until I crawl to your door”* — her return

Back to her: the pages settle BACK to the first night.

ON SCREEN

TIME → 11:47 · Friday, September 3, 2021 — the house reads SEPTEMBER · YEAR 1; the calendar pages roll to it (forward tears, backward settles) before any device appears

ERA FOOT LINE → “the first night”

14.4 BOTH · CATHY · Messages — CATHY: “I will be waiting for you!” — her LAST line before he stands; his text lands

THE ONE ANIMATION. The calendar docks; her phone lights on the steps: “home safe?” — the text the house watched him send in Shiksa Goddess. She opens it and starts to answer. SHE IS STILL TYPING when his last verse takes the stage.

ON SCREEN

TIME → 11:48

NOTIFICATION — Messages · Jamie (now): “home safe?”

... a beat (auto-timed, 1.5 s)

THREAD HISTORY — loads whole with the thread:

— Today · 10:42 PM

SENT (blue): “it’s cathy 😊 — from tonight”

— Today · 11:48 PM

RECEIVED (gray): “home safe?”

... a beat (auto-timed, 0.5 s)

TYPES LIVE (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed): “safe 😊 tonight was”

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — CATHY’s screen

sound: receive ding

TAP THE NOTIFICATION — a beat on the banner, Face ID passes, and the app opens DIRECTLY onto Messages. One motion.

No home screen. (No touch dot anywhere in the show — cut by direction; the screen’s own feedback carries every tap.)

sound: key clicks

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

tap thock

keyboard clicks (follow the projection rhythm)

PHONES BOTH = Messages · stamp “the first night” · clock 11:48

HOLD · *Do not send. It is the payoff of Shiksa Goddess, two hours ago.*

14.5 BOTH · CATHY — JAMIE: “You never noticed how the wind had changed” — he stands

The phone drops mid-word; the pages tear FORWARD to JUNE · YEAR 5 — the breakup — and hold as the last image while he sings his goodbye.

ON SCREEN

PHONE AWAY — the phone drops; the calendar returns to center-stage

TIME → 4:12 · Thursday, June 11, 2026 — the house reads JUNE · YEAR 5; the calendar pages roll to it (forward tears, backward settles) before any device appears

ERA FOOT LINE → “the last afternoon”

PLAYS

the device drops; the calendar takes center-stage (never black — true black is the curtain only)

SOUND

room tone out

HOLD · *Hold it. Do not resolve it.*

14.6 BOTH · CATHY — FINAL BLACKOUT — on the last “Goodbye”

Curtain: true black. End of show.

ON SCREEN

CURTAIN — true black; the calendar goes